

School Question Pack

The question does not end with us. We give it a push up the hill; the student keeps it moving.

PAINTED PLATE — HELD FOR CHAIRMAN SCENE-CONTRACT APPROVAL

Contract SC-615-04 · no image generated (rule of Chairman rejection 614)

A classroom in mid-exchange: one student speaking with a hand still raised, others turned toward her, the board showing one equation.

Five one-period lessons for teachers and home educators. Students practise telling what they **know** from what they **guess**, reading an equation as a sentence, and — most of all — asking the next question instead of stopping at an answer. Nothing is collected from students.

For the teacher

Each lesson: warm-up (5 min) · activity (25 min) · exchange (10 min) · exit ticket (5 min).
Grade band: upper elementary to middle school; adjust numbers up or down.

Four sorting labels used in every lesson (Position Mathematics, sequence 601)

Label	Meaning	Student says
KNOWN	Checked, with a source	"I saw it, and here is where."
INFERENCE	A reasonable guess from what is known	"I think so, because..."
UNKNOWN	Not known yet	"We don't know yet. We could find out by..."
CONTRADICTION	Two claims that cannot both be true	"These disagree. Which one has the better source?"

Lesson 1 — Sort it

Read each line aloud. Students hold up KNOWN, INFERENCE, UNKNOWN or CONTRADICTION, then say why.

Statement	Label
The thermometer outside says 12 °C.	
It will rain after lunch.	
Maya was late because she overslept.	
The bus schedule says 8:05; the bus came at 8:20.	
Everyone in our town likes football.	

Lesson 2 — The next-question ladder

Start with any answer. Each student adds one rung: a question that the last answer makes possible. Stop only when the class cannot tell whether the next rung would be KNOWN or UNKNOWN — then plan how to find out.

Rung	
Rung	
Rung	
Rung	
Rung	

Lesson 3 — An exchange, not a lecture

One student reads a short paragraph. Everyone else writes one question about it. Questions are asked while hands are still raised — anyone can add to a question while it is being asked. The reader does not have to answer; the class decides together which questions can be answered from the paragraph and which need another source.

From the source (Chairman, sequence 608): “it’s not a talk, it’s an exchange ... what’s your next question?”

Lesson 4 — Read the equation like a sentence

$$N = P - F - T - D$$

“What is left equals what was paid, minus the fee, minus the tax, minus the cost of getting it to you.”

Class sale	P	F	T	D	N
Bake-sale cookie	\$1.00	\$0.00 cash	\$0.00	\$0.10 bag	
Card payment at a fair	\$5.00	\$0.45	\$0.00	\$0.00	

Students fill N, then ask: *who decides how N is shared?*

Lesson 5 — Count your own dance

Everyone hears the same beat. With eyes closed, each student moves the way they hear it for 16 counts. Then each counts their own steps, turns and claps and writes them down. Compare: same music, different counts. There is no single right two-step.

Safety: clear space, no running, anyone may sit it out and count claps instead. From the source (sequence 608).

Exit tickets

Name (optional)	One thing I KNOW now	One thing still UNKNOWN	My next question

Licence and price

Single teacher: print for your own students. No student data is collected; if you share student work with us, remove names first.

$N = P - F - T - D$ For one single-teacher copy: \$5.00 – \$0.45 card fee – T (sales tax, passed through) – \$0.00 delivery = \$4.55 – T. Then $N = B + C + A + O + R$, written down before the first sale.

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